

March 14th, 2025

Origin of Hope

With the market down over -10% from all time highs you don't have to walk too far to hear a bungler giving out financial advice. I'd recommend you cover your ears if you hear such a thing. Sure, seeing phantom gains evaporate can arouse unpleasant emotions, but they are just that...*phantom*.

I've learned quite a bit since beginning my investing journey, but one particular fact has stuck with me and reappears no matter who I'm learning from... *to try and predict the future is a loser's game*. The most famous economists of all time know this better than anyone, and they are perpetually wrong. Their line of business is in selling emotion and they seem to make a good living doing so.

I preface with the above commentary in hopes of removing some of my subsequent ignorance and hypocrisy. Like I've written about for months now, the Trump administration's relationship with the stock market will be built on and defined by *volatility*. This is how you enact acute change across the global financial markets. Trump understands our greatest asset is the US private capital market. Nowhere else in the world has such wealth been created.

"The world awaits the market open today, as DJT took the oath of office yesterday to become the 47th president of the United States. The new regime is sure to bring with it ample market volatility. I believe that is going to be a major theme for investors over the next four years."

January 21st, 2025

Luke C. Cagle

Whether it is the mention of tariffs, the bloody axe of DOGE, or DJT's honesty with the global "elites" of the World Economic Forum, the market is reacting with full spirit. People need to understand this is how it was during DJT's first term, to resist this would be tying oneself to the tracks of an oncoming freight train. Sit back and watch the obese US bureaucracy (aka NGOs) receive its first shot of GLP-1. If you're at this point and still wondering what this administration's goals are, you can count on this:

- Reduced income taxes
- Tariffs, Tariffs, Tariffs... or the threat of
- Reduced government spending aka inflation (Thanks Milton!)

Simple to read, hard to implement when you live in a country that is an addict of welfare and bureaucracy like the US. Thank God we are not Europe or Canada, though. Trump understands this and he knows with the previous administration we were headed right into the darkness of the aforementioned. This is the battlefield our generation will fight our entire lives on. A battle against what's sustainable and what's not.

In the short term, the trade off between big government and the free market may cause unrest, but it is necessary when backed against the abyss of unsustainability. People need to allow this to occur, and give the private economy some time. The short term risk of asset depreciation we face is a David

compared to the Goliath of unsustainable debt-financed, administratively imposed, deficient economic “growth”.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'L. Cagle', with a stylized, cursive script.

Luke Cagle
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